POWERPLAY — Round Reference Card

A Round is one fiscal quarter — 7 phases, each in turn order from the Leader unless noted. Upkeep is batched up front so player turns are pure play.

1. Morning News

- **Draw + read aloud 1 Universal Event** (the **Morning News**), then resolve it. *One-shot effects resolve now and end; ongoing effects + the event's Event Objective stay active **until the next Morning News** replaces it. If the Event deck is empty, shuffle its discard first.*
  - **Event Objective:** every Event carries an Objective — an **immediately-checkable** condition + a reward of **1 Power**, claimed **in the moment, by any player, once per player per event**.

2. Opening Bell (Batch Upkeep)

In turn order from the Leader, each player completes upkeep **before any player turns begin**:

- **Draw Hands**: discard any number of Action/Reaction cards, then refill (free) to **3 Action + 2 Reaction** from the Action deck and Reaction deck. *(Refill target, not a per-turn cap.)*
- **Refill Deal Tokens** to 2. *That is the whole phase. Income is rolled at Call-it-a-Night (phase 7). Card buying happens at **The Inbox** (the start of each player's turn): up to 1 Action (2 C) + 1 Reaction (1 C) per turn, each draw-2-keep-1.*

3. Market Operation (Pre-Market Sealed-Bid Draft)

Asset bidding with the Coins you hold. Opt in. In order from the Leader, each participant pulls 1 Asset into a shared row (Pull eligibility — T1: any; T2: 2 P + 4 C; T3: 3 P + 7 C). Secret Coin bids → reveal simultaneously → resolve highest-first: pick an Asset **of the tier you pulled** (or a higher tier you are eligible for), pay your bid (min ½ printed cost — T1 ≥ 2 / T2 ≥ 4 / T3 ≥ 7), gain Signing Bonus. **Lower tier only if none of your tier remains** — then the highest tier still available, still paying your full bid (a lone T1 is taken at the price bid). Only if every remaining Asset is above your Power is the bid returned. A 1-Coin player bids all-in, resolves last, takes a leftover. Ties → turn order from the Leader. Leftovers → bottom of decks.

4. Market Manipulation — Phase 1 (First Player Turns)

- All players take their **first** turn (turn order from the Leader).
- Each turn = **The Inbox** → **Action** → **Organize the Desk** (see the Turn Reference Card).

5. Lunch Break (Mid-Round Economy)

Two sub-phases, resolved in this order — each sub-phase in turn order from the Leader:

1. **Afternoon News:** draw + read aloud a **2nd** Universal Event (the **Afternoon News**); resolve it. Active **until the next Afternoon News** → it **overlaps into the next round's first half**. Two Events are now active (Morning + Afternoon), each with an Event Objective.
2. **Private Equity (Broker an Asset Deal):** pay a fee (T1 = 1 C, T2 = 2 C, T3 = 3 C), draw the top 2 of one Asset deck you meet the Buy Floor for, buy 1 at printed cost (gain Signing Bonus), discard the other.

Loans, deals, and Asset sales happen at any time you are not in the middle of a resolution (any turn, the Lunch Break, Debt Settlement — not during Market Operation bidding or while an Action / fire / Reaction resolves). **Loan:** borrow against an **unmortgaged** Asset for ½ its printed cost (rounded down); the Asset becomes Mortgaged; max 2 active. **Sale:** sell an **unmortgaged** Asset to the bank for its printed cost, or to another player as a deal. **Deal:** voluntary two-party; eligible contents = **Action / Reaction cards + Asset cards + Coins + IOUs**; each deal costs each party a **Deal Token** (2 per player, refilled at the Opening Bell); a creditor may sell an outstanding IOU to a third party (the buyer collects from the original debtor at Call-it-a-Night). *Influence and Power are NOT tradable — converting your own resources is not trading.*

6. Market Manipulation — Phase 2 (Second Player Turns)

- All players take their **second** turn (turn order from the Leader).

7. Call-it-a-Night

Each player settles their **own** books (turn order from the Leader); only contested IOU steps are interactive. *Loans and deals remain available throughout.*

- **Income Roll**: roll **one die per Asset tier you own** — **T1 = D4 + 1, T2 = D6, T3 = D10** — all together. The **die face = Coins paid per Asset** of that tier (each T1 Asset adds +1; Frozen Assets still earn income; both active Events apply). **Reroll Tokens**: spend one to reroll one die (2 per game, never replenished). Subtract **Operating Costs** (T3 = 1 C per Asset; T1 and T2 = 0) before collecting. *Cannot cover a payment → Bankruptcy Resolution (emergency Loan available at once).*
- **Currency Conversion**: 3 C = 1 IP | 2 IP = 1 P (your own resources only; forward only).
- **Debt Settlement** (in order — Loans are player ↔ supply; IOUs are player-to-player, Defender owes Attacker; loans and deals may be struck during these steps):
  1. Voluntary loan principal repayment (clears mortgage; paid to supply)
  2. Loan maintenance fees (1 C per active loan to supply, except grace round)
  3. Voluntary IOU repayment (Defender pays Coins to current IOU holder)
  4. IOU negotiation (Defender + Attacker / IOU holder agree on forgiveness / partial / asset trade)
  5. Forced IOU liquidation (unpaid IOU → Defender liquidates unencumbered Asset; bank pays Asset cost to Defender; Defender pays IOU holder MIN(IOU, available C))
  6. Elimination (only if IOU unpaid AND no unencumbered Assets AND no negotiated agreement)
- **Thievery**: if the player with the lowest Power is not the Leader, they steal the Leader Token and assign it to any player (ties → earliest in turn order decides).

If not the final round, a new Round begins with Morning News.

End of Final Round → Clean the Books → Board Meeting

After the final Call-it-a-Night: settle every outstanding loan (pay principal + 1 C, or default per the Loan default mechanic). No elimination from loan default. Then score: `Total Power = Power + floor(IP/2) + floor(C/6) + floor(AssetValue/5)` .